



A logical afterlife?

Universe for our benefit. Because there is a law like gravity, the Universe can and will create itself from nothing. Spontaneous creation is the reason there is something rather than nothing, why the Universe exists, why we exist.” Drawing inspiration and comparing their argument to Darwin and Wallace’s theory of evolution, Hawking and Mlodinow make some very valid deductions of reasoning.

Score: Science: 2 / God: 1

The Qualia of religious belief

First used by Clarence Irving Lewis, an early 20th Century American philosopher, ‘qualia’ is loosely used to refer to individual instances of subjective, conscious experience. The theory of Qualia states that the personal experience of any individual is impossible to replicate identically with another. Even with something as simple as the perception of colour. We all know what each colour is supposed to look like. We define it by giving it a name. For example, the colour green. While most of us can distinguish green from the other colours, our perception of the colour itself is unique to each of us. We have no way of proving that the other person sees ‘green’ the same way as we do. While each of us can point out the colour off a lineup of colours, actually perceiving it the way others do is beyond our capabilities. Similarly, each individual’s experience with their belief in a higher power is unquantifiable. Which is where the gap in communication between the atheists and theists occurs. The lack of personal experience either way is one which is beyond anyone to bridge. Divine faith or any other kind of belief is meant

to personal and tailored to each individual. At least until science advances to a level of telepathic communication.

Score: Science: 3 / God: 1

The logic behind wagering on the afterlife

Whoever said religion and religious belief was illogical? Sure, blind faith of any kind may seem to lack fundamental logic, but even logic can have a justification for the religious belief of life beyond death. Blaise Pascal was the man to look at the situation beyond bias of any kind. Religious beliefs of any kind have one major lifestyle choice in common – If you do good things, you shall be rewarded in the afterlife. The logic behind Pascal’s theory renders the belief in that theory as a whole redundant to the outcome. Assuming you do believe in life after death, the outcomes are set out in front of you. But even if you don’t believe, there are two possible outcomes – first, that there is life after death, at which point, doing good deeds may indeed be a good idea. Second, there isn’t an afterlife. In which case, it doesn’t matter anyway. Logically, being a good person doesn’t really have a downside. Ergo: be a nice person. Period.

Of course, there is always the underlying counter-argument to the same. What if doing good deeds doesn’t take you to heaven, and that the philosophy behind it is a massive ruse propagated by whichever evil ruler of the afterlife you believe in to ensure that you make your way to the dark side? Skidoosh. However, considering we’re looking at a fair, just and balanced world, we can disregard

that assumption and go with what we know people believe as a whole. So:

Score: Science: 3 / God: 2

Scientific theory beyond the intellectually elite

Scientific fact is not a subject comprehended by many, including several hundred thousands of people who accept scientific fact as dogma (yes, we see the irony). If someone tells you about the Higgs Boson and preaches the mathematical proof of its existence, it may not be comprehended by every interested person in all its glory. Yet, the existence of the God particle is accepted by the scientific community as large since it has been verified by experts in that particular field. When seen in this light, majority of people who believe in it do so at face value. Why then, should a person who has studied the path of the divine all their life not be taken seriously. Why is it so difficult to take something so metaphysical as a supreme power at face value? Is faith a matter of hypocrisy? Or are some people simply more conditioned to believe that scientists are more trustworthy than a person of God?

Score: Science: 3 / God: 3



God, give us the strength...

Why the stalemate?

Despite any arguments presented by people, Science and God have really done nothing to be butting heads. They are – like most ideals and beliefs – content in being exactly where they are, existing for the sake of existence. Their enmity is a fallacy that we, being mortal human beings propagate to feel good about ourselves. They are, in fact, the idiomatic philosophers who meet every weekend for a nice long talk over scotch and cigars, chuckling amongst themselves, sharing the joke mankind so retardedly strives to understand. **[1]**